

Student Innovator Pitch Template

For pitching to ecosystem stakeholders (incubators, institutions, industry & government partners)

Suggested length: 6–8 minutes pitch + 3 - 4 minutes Q&A

Format: 8–10 slides (keep one core idea per slide)

Goal: Don't just describe your idea - show stakeholders *where they fit*. Every pitch should end with a clear ask and a proposed role for the people in the room.

How to use this template

Fill in each section in your own words. The right-hand cue tells you the *purpose* of the slide so you stay focused. Time yourself — running over is the most common reason pitches lose the room.

Slide-by-slide structure

1. Title & Hook (30 sec)

- Project name + one-line tagline ("We help ___ do ___ so that ___").
- Your name, school/ATL/institution, and team.
- Open with a single striking line: a statistic, a question, or a 10-second story of the problem.

Purpose: earn attention in the first 15 seconds.

2. The Problem (1 min)

- What real-world problem are you solving? Who faces it?
- Why does it matter *now*?
- Keep it concrete and local where possible — stakeholders connect with problems they recognize.

Purpose: make the problem feel real and worth solving.

3. Your Solution / Idea (1.5 min)

- What exactly is your idea? Describe it in plain language.

- Show it: a prototype photo, a sketch, a demo video, or a working model from your ATL / maker space.
- What makes it different from existing approaches?

Purpose: prove you have a real, buildable idea — not just a concept.

4. How It Works & Current Stage (1 min)

- Brief on the technology / method behind it.
- Be honest about your stage: idea → prototype → tested → early users. Stakeholders fund honesty, not hype.
- One line on what you've validated so far (a test, a user, a result).

Purpose: show feasibility and momentum.

5. Impact & Opportunity (1 min)

- Who benefits and how many? What changes if this succeeds?
- The bigger opportunity: market, scale, or social impact.

Purpose: show the idea is worth backing.

6. Where the Ecosystem Fits (1 min) — the most important slide for this conclave

Map out which stakeholders you need and *why*. Be specific:

Stakeholder	What you need from them
Incubators / high-tech makers' spaces	e.g., prototyping space, equipment, technical mentoring
Institutions	e.g., lab access, expert guidance, validation
Industry partners	e.g., pilot opportunity, real-world testing, supply chain
Government agencies	e.g., regulatory guidance, scheme support, scale-up help

Purpose: this is how a pitch becomes a partnership. Show stakeholders their exact role.

7. Your Ask (45 sec)

- State clearly and confidently what you want: mentorship, incubation, a pilot, seed support, an introduction.

- Be specific. "We're looking for a 3-month mentorship and access to a high-tech maker space to build version 2" beats "any help would be great."

Purpose: make it easy for someone to say yes.

8. Plan of Action (Next 90 Days) (45 sec)

A short roadmap with **roles**:

- Milestone 1 → who does it (you / your mentor / partner)
- Milestone 2 → who does it
- Milestone 3 → who does it

Purpose: show you're ready to act, and you've thought about shared responsibility.

9. Team & Closing (30 sec)

- One line on why your team can pull this off.
- Close by repeating the tagline + the ask. End on energy, not a fade-out.
- Thank-you slide with contact details so stakeholders can follow up.

One-page pitch summary (leave-behind)

Hand this to every stakeholder so the conversation continues after the conclave.

- **Project:**
- **Team & institution:**
- **Problem:**
- **Solution (1–2 lines):**
- **Current stage:**
- **What we're asking for:**
- **Stakeholders we'd love to work with:**
- **Contact:**

Delivery tips for students

- **Practice out loud at least 5 times.** A pitch read off a slide is forgettable.
- **One idea per slide, big visuals, few words.** The slides support you; they aren't your script.
- **Show, don't just tell.** A 20-second prototype demo beats two slides of explanation.
- **Speak to the people in the room.** Make eye contact, name the kind of partner you're hoping to meet.

- **Prepare for 3 likely questions:** How is this different? What's your biggest risk? What do you need most right now?
- **Stay within time.** Going over signals you can't prioritise — a red flag for any partner.
- **End with a clear next step,** not "thank you, any questions?" Try: "We'd love to set up a follow-up — who here would be the right person to talk to?"